

Phase 7.2 - Password Policies

Review the Existing Domain Policy

Open Group Policy Management and navigate to:

Forest: <yourname>.lab > Domains > <yourname>.lab

Select Default Domain Policy

Edit the Policy

Right-click Default Domain Policy and choose Edit

Navigate to:

Computer Configuration > Policies > Windows Settings > Security Settings > Account Policies > Password Policy

You should see several password related settings

Configure the Values

Double-click and modify each setting. For example:

Enforce Password History – *5 passwords remembered*

Maximum Password Age – *90 days*

Minimum Password Age – *1 day*

Minimum Password Length – *8 Characters*

Password Must Meet Complexity Requirements – *Enabled*

With complexity enabled, passwords cannot be simple items such as:

password

welcome

12345678

sales123

Instead, they must contain a mixture of character types such as:

Sales2026!

HelpDesk#7

Password!23

Apply and Close

After configuring all settings, click **Apply** then **OK**.

Close the editor

Update the Policy

On CLIENT-1, open Command Prompt as Administrator.

Run the command gpupdate /force

Wait for completion

Verify the Policy

Choose one of the existing test accounts and attempt to intentionally change the password to something weak such as:

password

Expected Result:

Password change rejected